

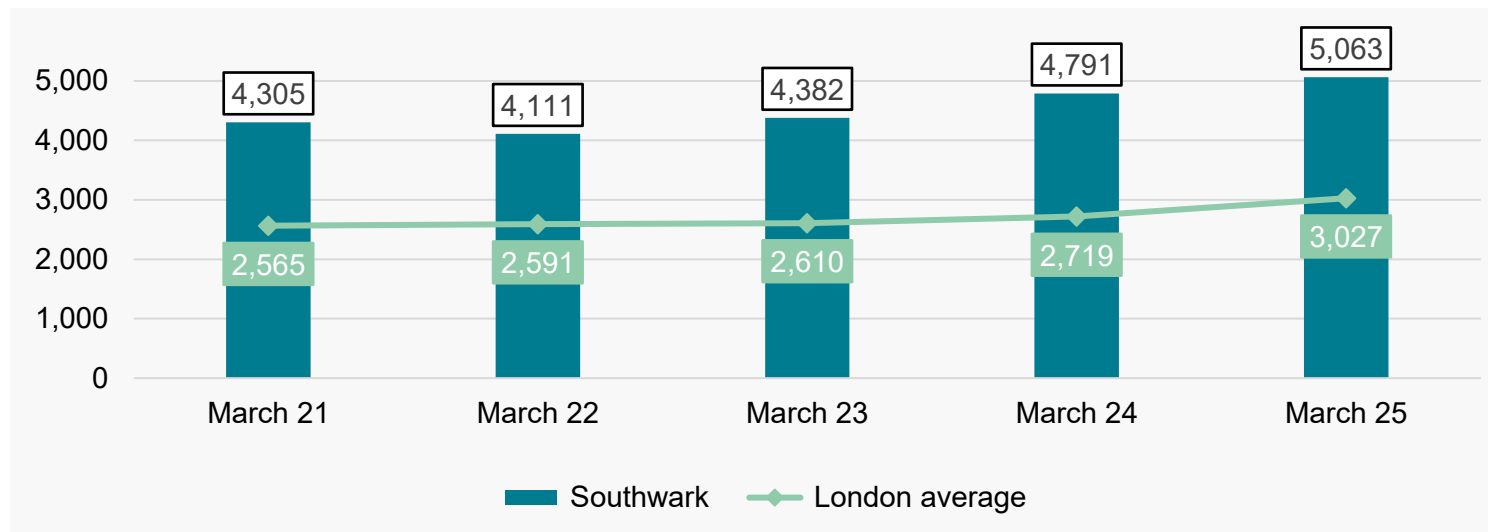
Annual Workforce Profile

2024/25

1 Size of workforce: headcount

This is a count of the number of individuals directly employed by the council on 31 March every year. It includes all full-time and part-time employees but excludes casual workers and agency workers.

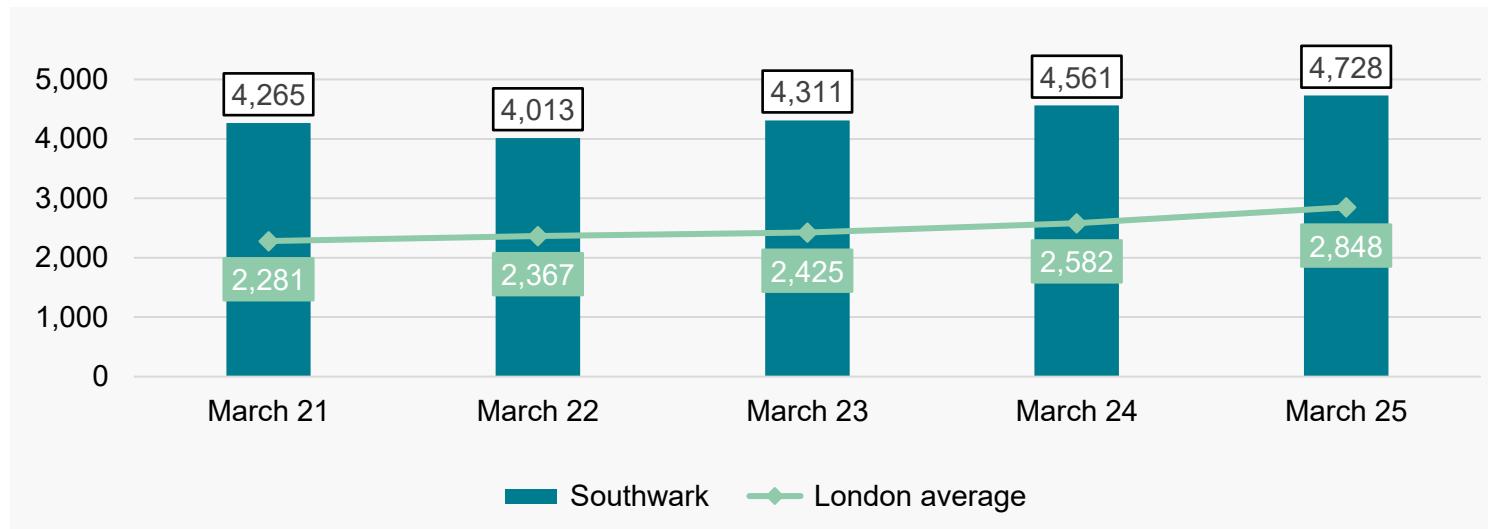
Southwark's headcount is the highest of all the London boroughs, in part reflecting the council's commitment to in-house service delivery. In June 2023, over 400 employees transferred into the council as part of the insourcing of leisure centres.



2 Size of workforce: full-time equivalent (FTE)

This is a count of the number of full-time equivalent (FTE) individuals directly employed by the council on 31 March every year. FTE converts the total number of hours worked by employees into an equivalent number of full-time roles. Casual workers and agency workers are excluded from the calculation.

When measured by FTE, Southwark's workforce is the second largest in London.

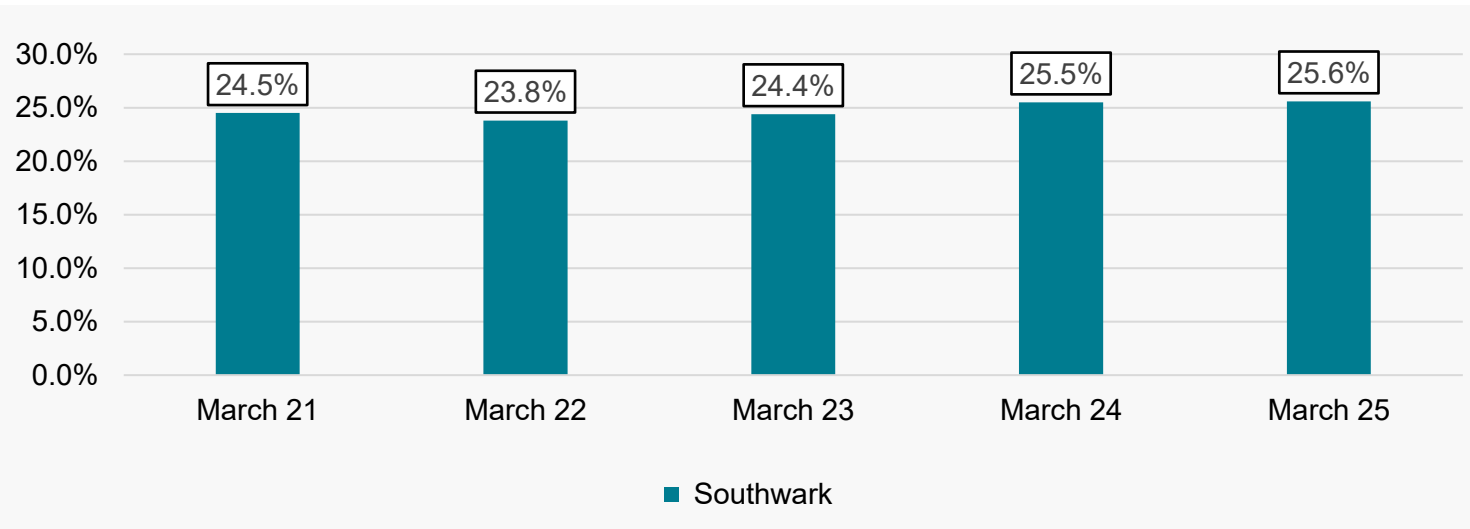


3 Percentage of employees who are Southwark residents

The percentage of employees who are Southwark residents has remained broadly stable over the last five years. In London, the labour market is regional, rather than council-specific, as many people can easily travel to other London boroughs.

The council will continue to promote employment opportunities to Southwark residents by:

- supporting Southwark Works, the council's employment service
- advertising internships and apprenticeships locally

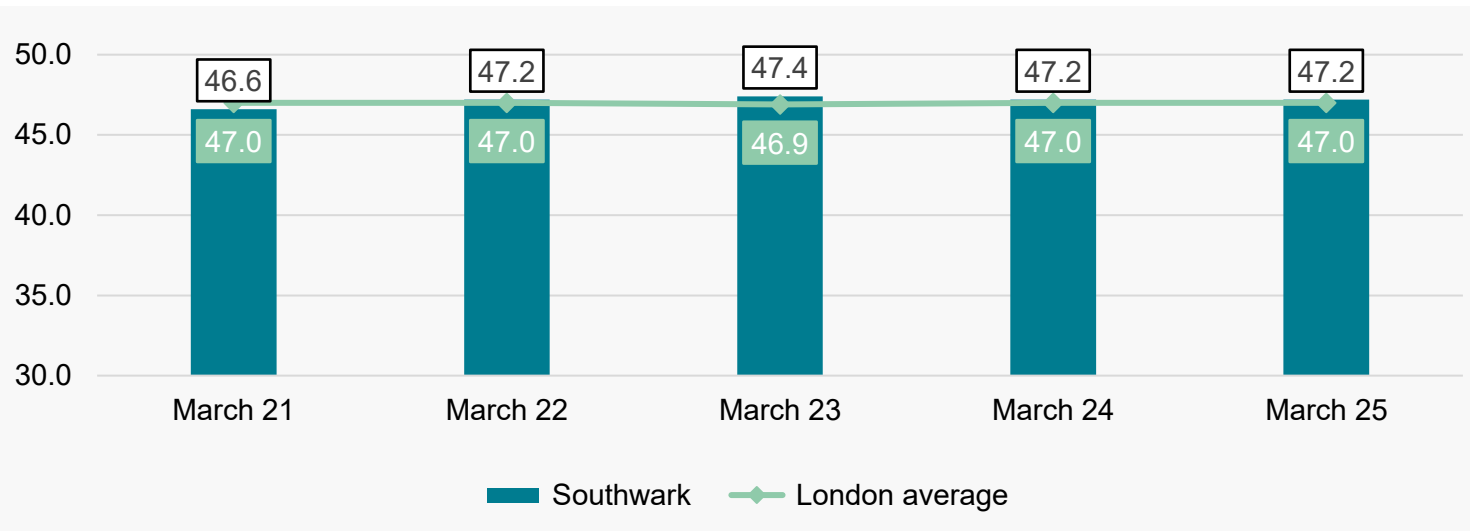


4 Average age of the workforce

The average age of the workforce is broadly in line with the London average.

Most, if not all, councils report an ageing workforce. This reflects low turnover among long-serving staff, the specialist skills and qualifications required for some roles, and increasing competition for talent.

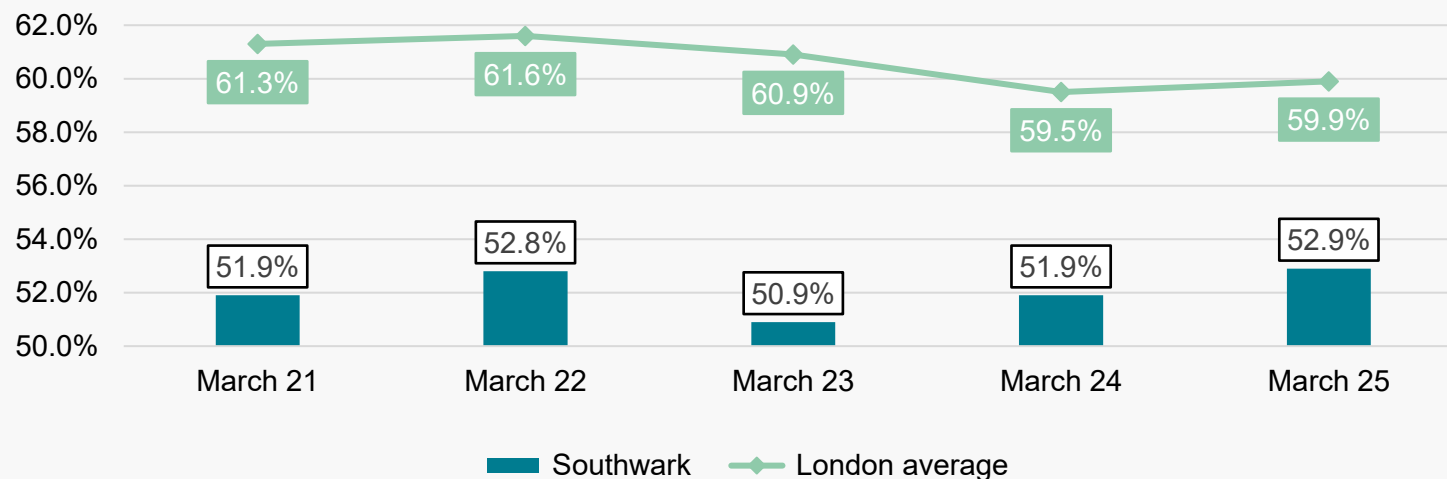
The HR service has established a dedicated apprenticeships and early careers team, which is focused on growing the number of younger people who join the council.



5 Percentage of employees who are female

Southwark has a lower proportion of women in its workforce than any other London council. This is largely due to decisions about in-house and outsourced service delivery. In Southwark, male-dominated services such as responsive repairs and grounds maintenance – which many councils have outsourced – continue to be provided in-house.

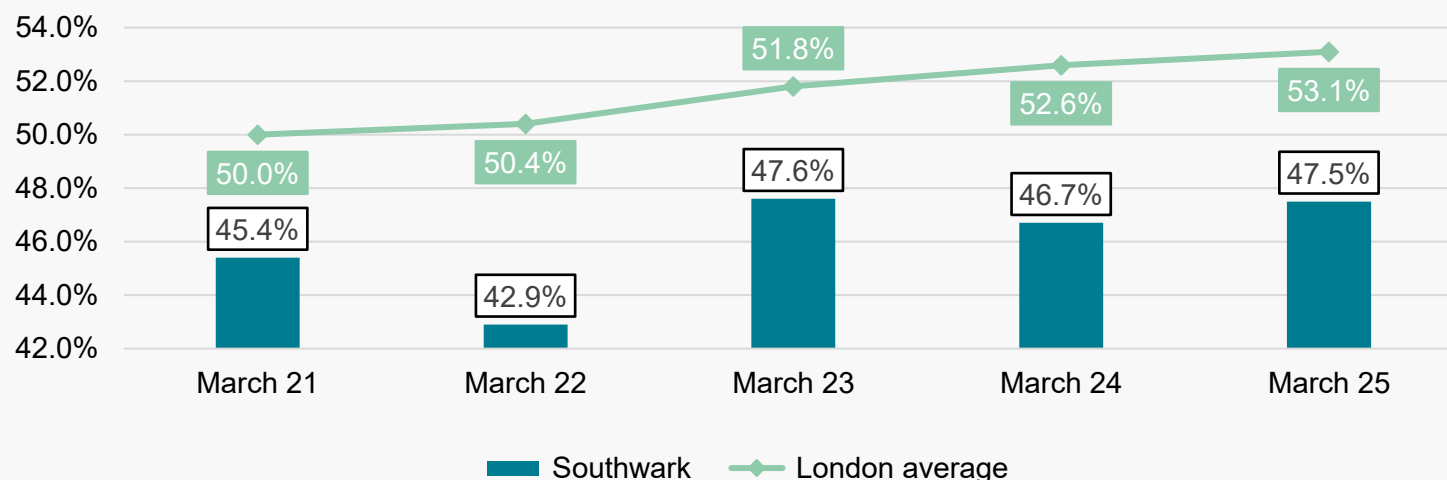
As a result, although women make up more than half of all employees, the gender profile of the workforce is more male than the London average.



6 Percentage of top 5% of earners who are female

In common with the position across London, women are under-represented in the top 5% of earners compared to their representation in the workforce as a whole.

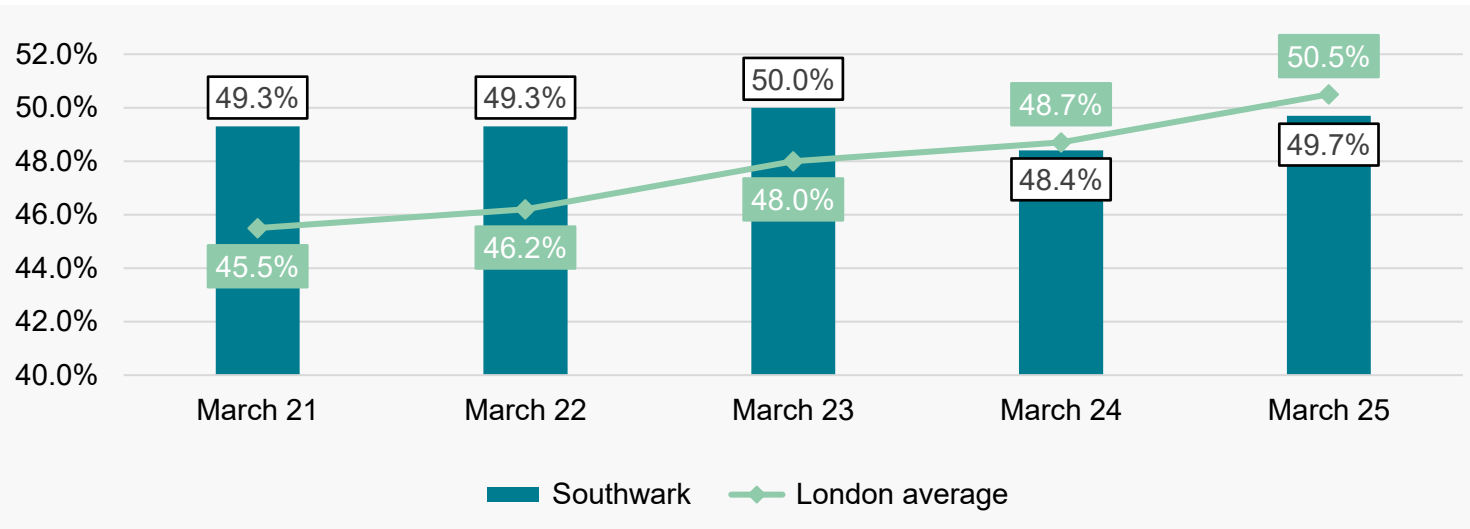
There are well-known societal and structural barriers that can impact on women's career progression, including historic under-representation and reduced options for flexible working in senior roles. The HR team will lead the development of an action plan to increase the representation of women in senior roles.



7 Percentage of employees who are ethnically diverse

The ethnic profile of the workforce is broadly reflective of Southwark's community: nearly 50% of employees are ethnically diverse compared to 48.5% of Southwark residents.

In 23/24, the proportion of ethnically diverse employees reduced following the transfer of 400 employees into the council as part of the insourcing of leisure centres. Initially, the council did not hold ethnicity data for any of these employees. This is being addressed through ongoing data collection.

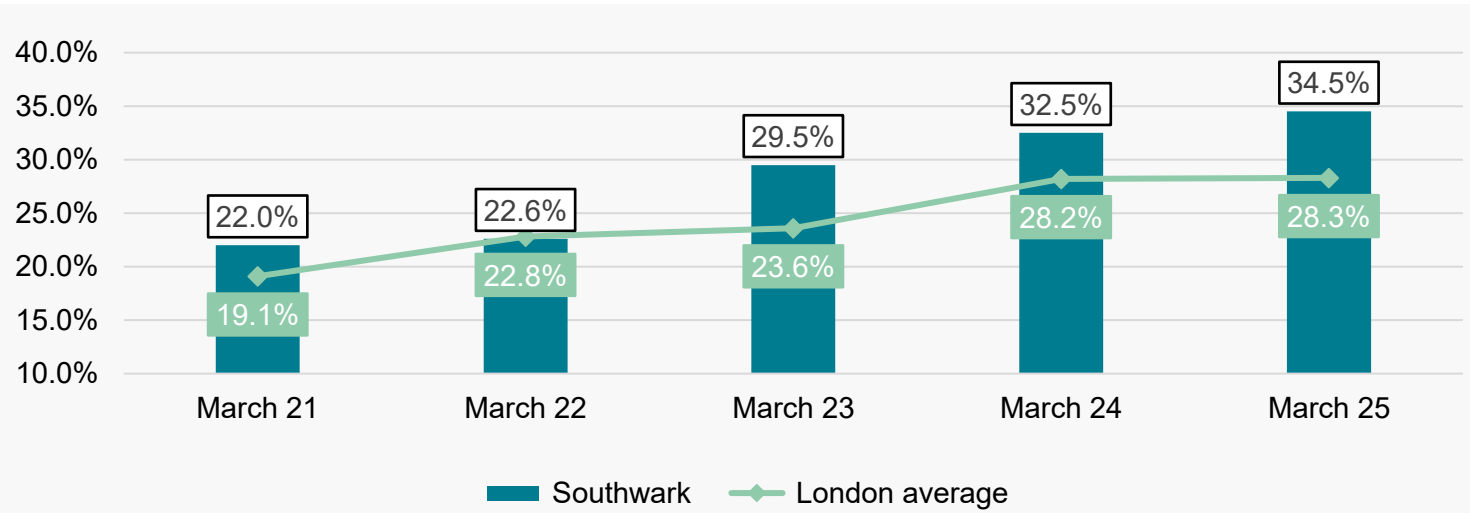


8 Percentage of top 5% of earners who are ethnically diverse

Over the last four years, the representation of ethnically diverse employees in the top 5% of earners has increased by over twelve percentage points. This reflects the council's focus on improving ethnic diversity in senior leadership roles as part of Southwark Stands Together.

Further improvement will be delivered through:

- targeted action planning with service departments
- continued tracking and reporting on progress

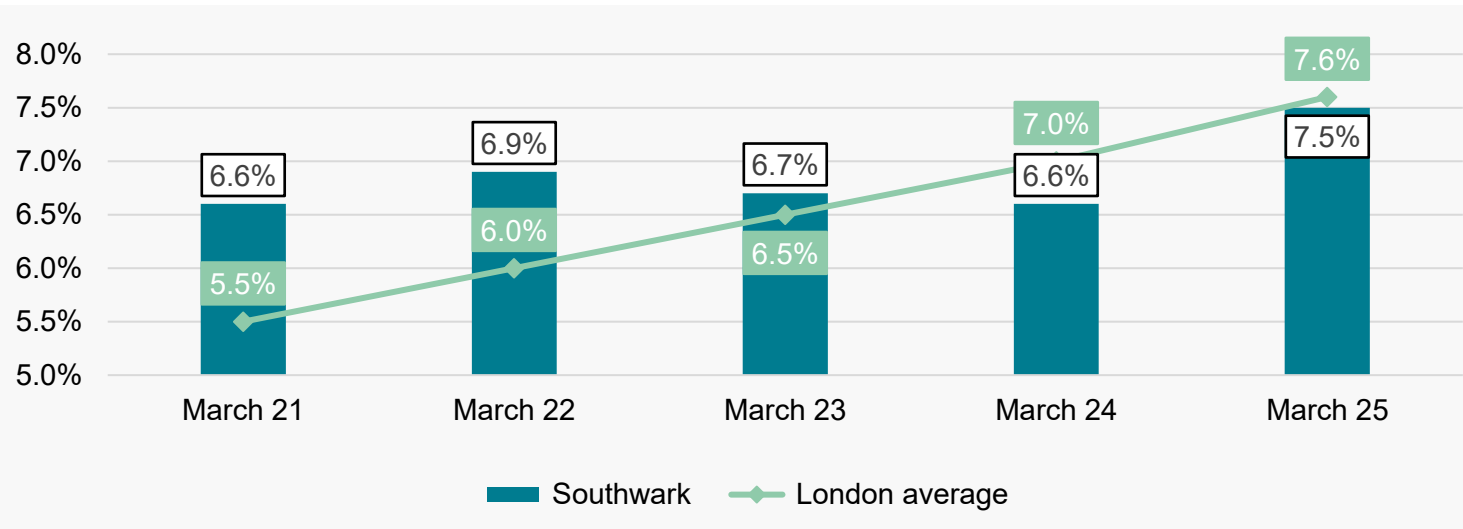


9 Percentage of employees who are disabled

The proportion of employees who are disabled is broadly in line with the London average. However, only 52% of employees have recorded their disability status in the council's HR system.

The HR team will run a campaign to encourage more employees to declare their disability status, including:

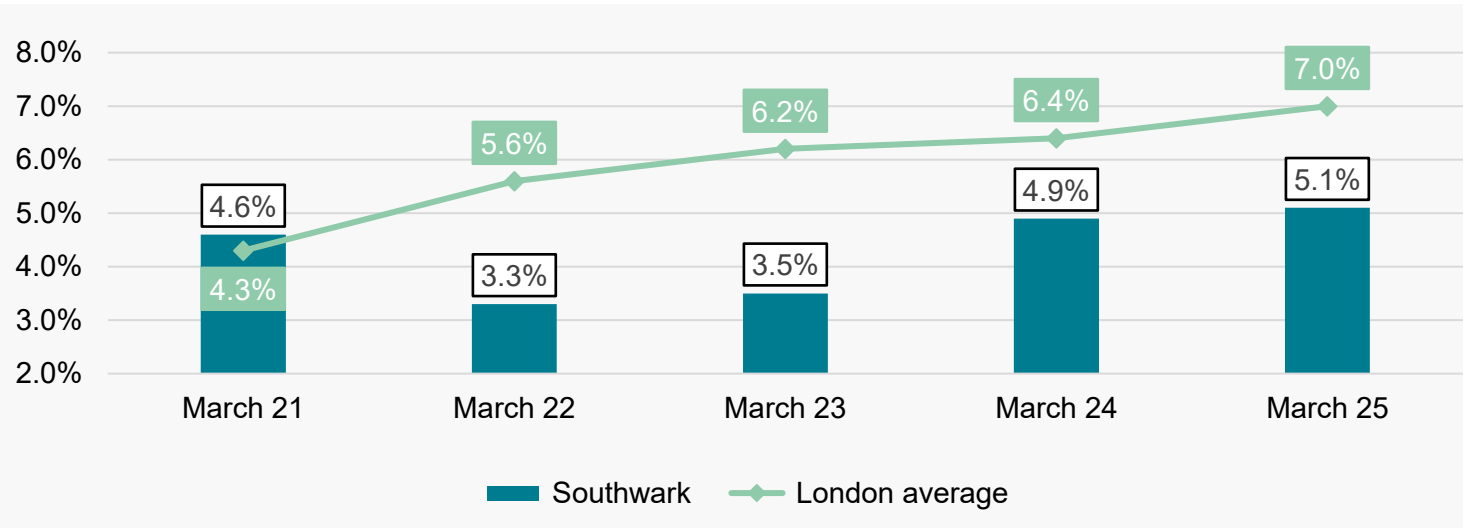
- targeted communications
- collaboration with trade unions and staff networks to promote the value of recording this data



10 Percentage of top 5% of earners who are disabled

In line with the trend across London, disabled employees are under-represented in the top 5% of earners compared to their representation in the workforce as a whole. This position may change as more employees record their disability status in the council's HR system.

The HR team will lead the development of an action plan to increase the representation of disabled employees in senior roles.

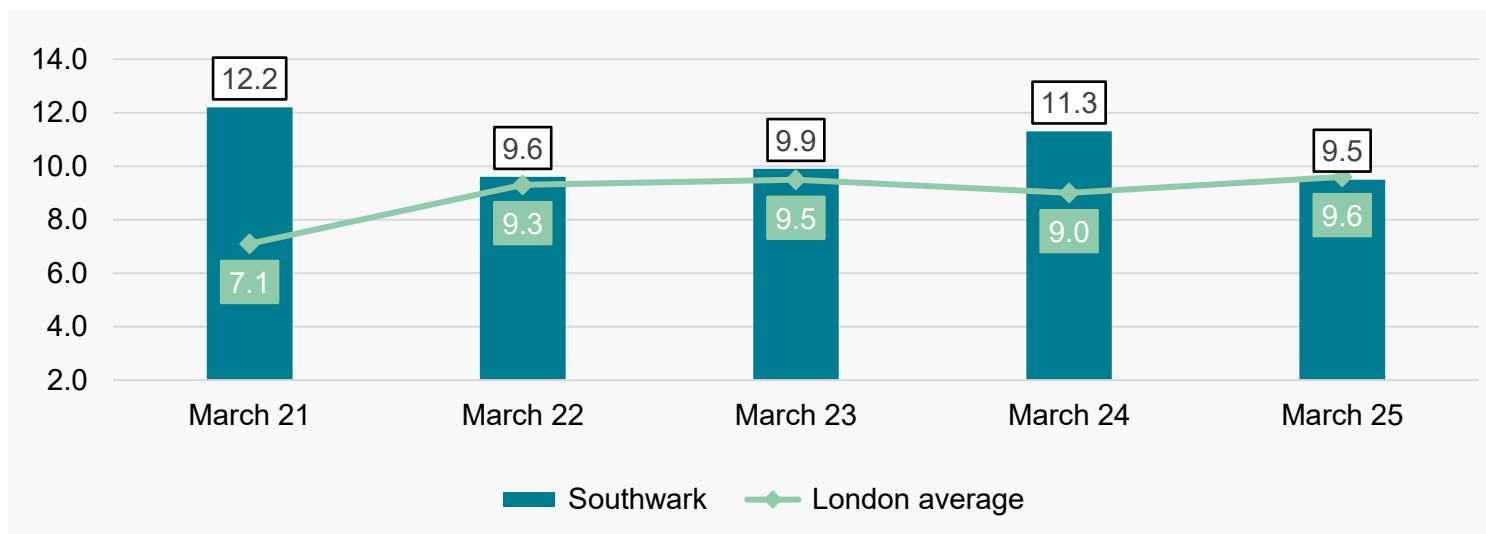


11 Sickness absence: average number of days lost per employee in the previous year

The average number of days lost to sickness absence is broadly in line with the London average and shows a clear improvement from the peak recorded in 23/24.

The HR team has initiated a project to review and improve the council's approach to managing sickness absence. Key areas of focus include:

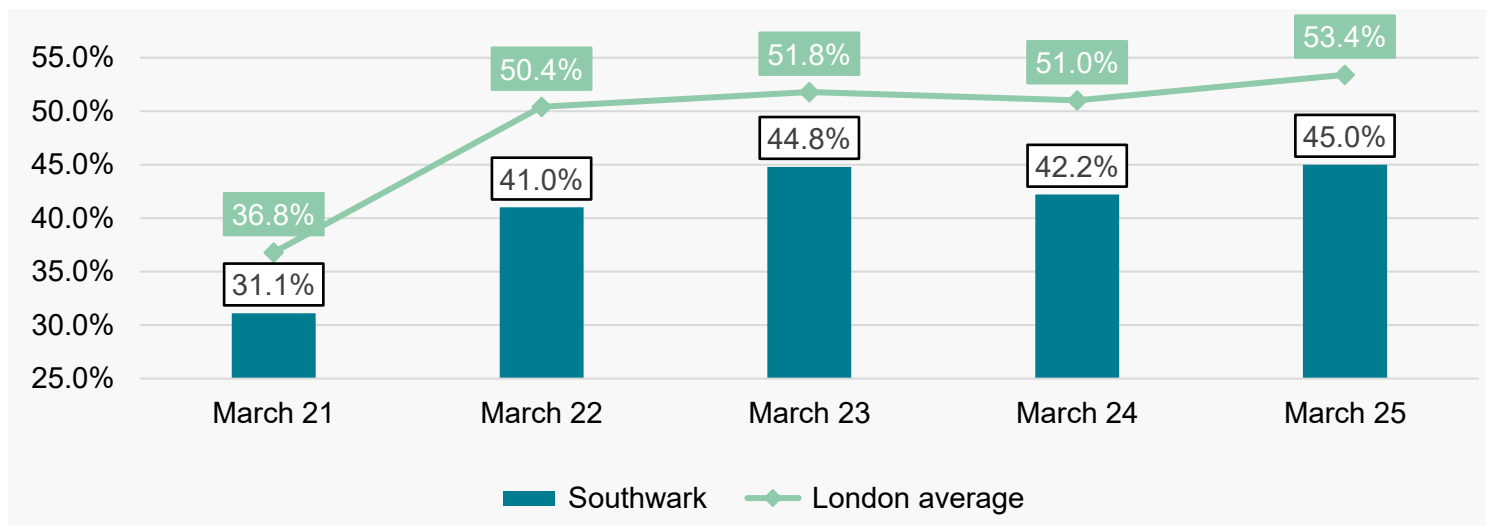
- training for managers
- support for employees, including the use of occupational health and reasonable adjustments
- data quality and trend analysis



12 Sickness absence: percentage of employees who had sickness in the previous year

The percentage of employees with sickness absence is lower than the London average; however, the average number of days lost per employee is consistent with the London trend. Taken together, this suggests that Southwark may have a higher rate of long-term sickness absence than the norm.

The sickness absence project initiated by the HR team has a specific focus on long-term sickness absence, including analysis of its causes and any underlying patterns or trends.

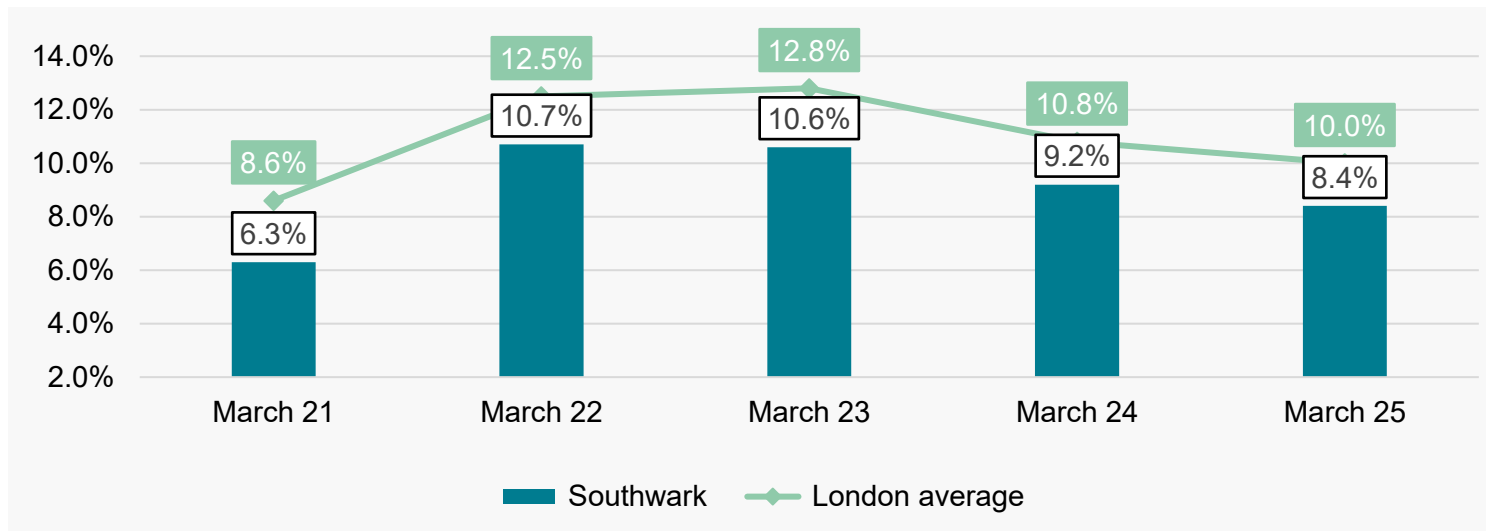


13 Turnover: percentage of employees who left during the previous year

The turnover rate at Southwark is one of the lowest in London: only Camden and Islington councils have a lower turnover.

High turnover can disrupt service delivery, reduce institutional knowledge, and increase spend on recruitment and training.

Conversely, employers with low turnover can regard it as a concern. Long-tenured staff may resist change, while new employees can bring fresh perspectives and challenge established ways of working.

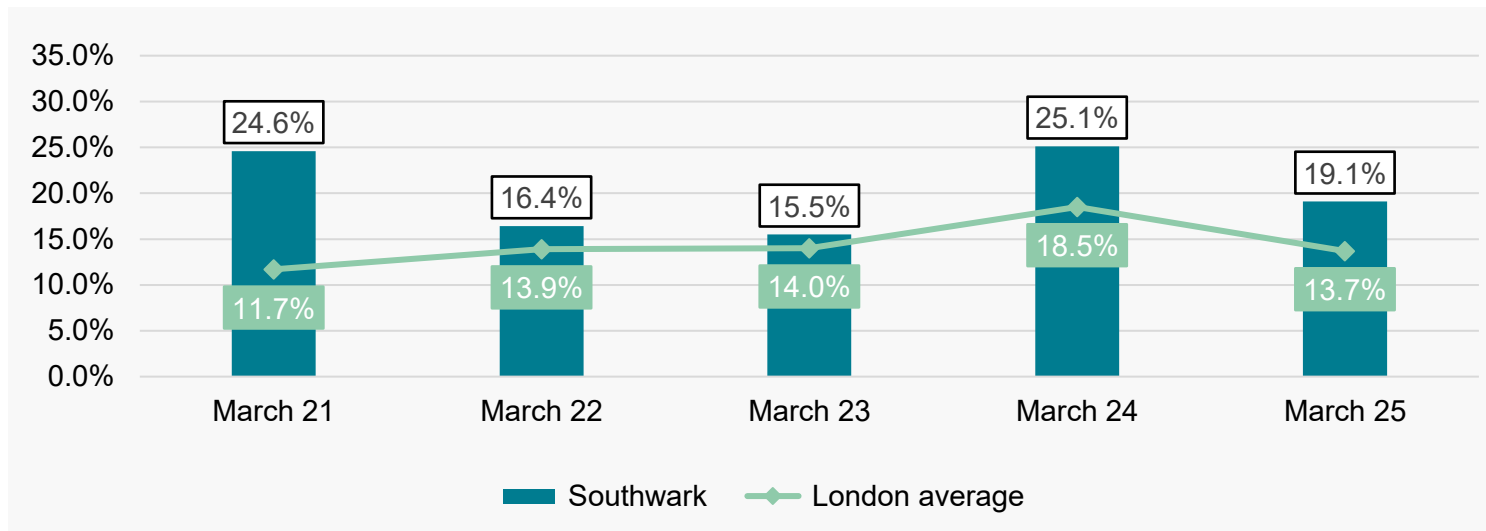


14 Turnover: percentage of leavers in the previous year with less than one year of service

A high percentage of early leavers may suggest that new employees are not well-matched to their employer, which in turn may highlight issues with recruitment processes.

At Southwark, while turnover is low, the rate of early leavers is consistently above the London average. However, the reasons for this are not well-understood.

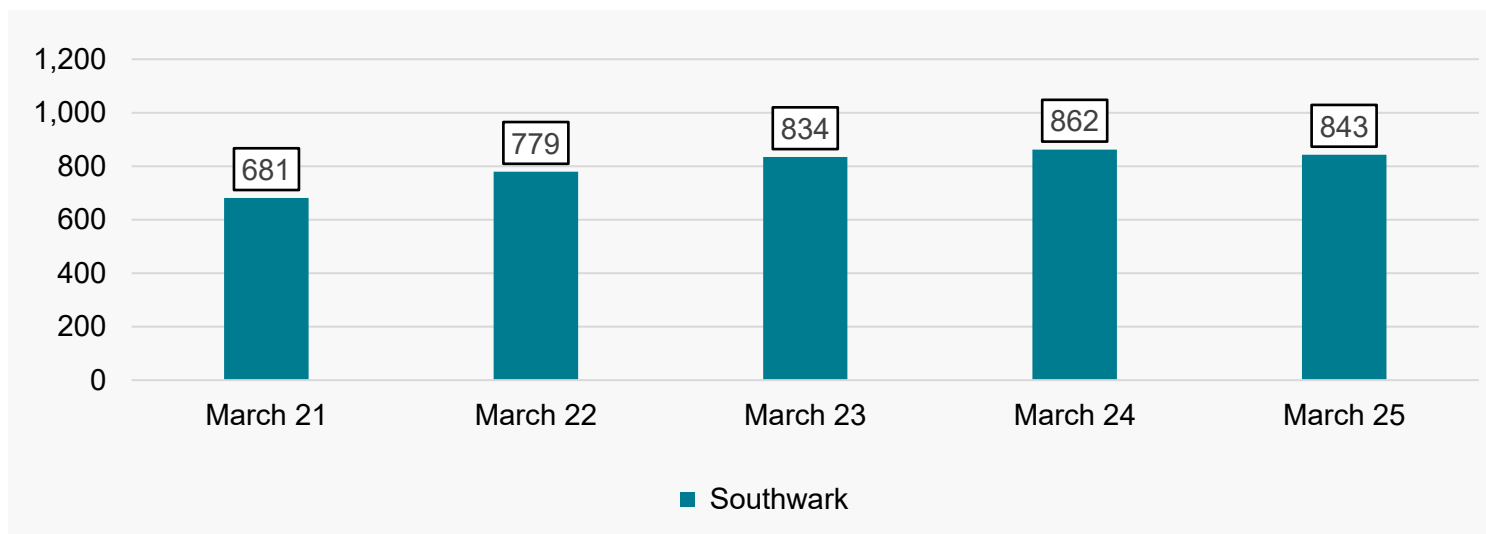
The HR team will introduce an exit interview process to better understand why employees leave and identify opportunities for improvement.



15 Agency workers: headcount

This is a count of the number of agency workers engaged by the council on 31 March every year. Agency workers are used to cover short-term vacancies or specialist roles that are difficult to fill on a permanent basis.

Most agency workers are engaged through the council's contract with Matrix, who manage a supply chain of agencies on the council's behalf. Matrix are responsible for sourcing suitable candidates and negotiating agency rates.



16 Percentage of the workforce who are agency workers

The percentage of the workforce who are agency workers, while declining, is higher than the London average. This indicates there is scope to further reduce the use of agency workers.

In April 2024, the council established an in-house recruitment team as part of a wider transformation of the HR service. This team will lead the development of an action plan to reduce the use of agency workers through increased permanent recruitment and regular scrutiny of all roles filled by agency workers.

